

Attendance and Working Hours Policy

Company Name	TCS (Tera Company Service)
Document Title	Attendance and Working Hours Policy
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Department	Human Resources
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1. Purpose

This policy sets out the rules governing attendance, standard working hours, late arrival, early departure, and unauthorized absence for TCS employees, ensuring consistent tracking and fair treatment across all teams.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all TCS employees across all office locations and approved WFH arrangements.

3. Definitions

Core Hours	The window during which all employees must be available/present, 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST.
Biometric Attendance	Attendance recorded via fingerprint/face-recognition devices at office entry points.
Unauthorized Absence	Absence from work without an approved leave request in the LMS.

4. Standard Working Hours and Office Timings

The standard working day at TCS is 9 hours, including a 1-hour lunch break, totaling 40 hours per week across Monday–Friday. Standard office timing is **9:30 AM to 6:30 PM IST**. Teams supporting US or EU clients may be assigned shifted hours (e.g., 1:00 PM to 10:00 PM IST) as communicated by their Reporting

Manager, with a shift allowance applied per the Employee Benefits Policy.

5. Flexible Working Hours

TCS operates a flexible-start policy for most roles: employees may start their working day any time between 8:30 AM and 10:30 AM, provided they complete 9 working hours and are present during **Core Hours (11:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST)**, when all employees must be available for meetings and collaboration. Client-facing and shift-based roles follow fixed timings as defined by their project.

6. Attendance Requirements

All employees must mark attendance daily using one of the following methods:

- Biometric check-in/check-out at office entry points, for employees working from office.
- Digital check-in via the employee portal's Attendance module, for approved WFH days.

Attendance must be marked within 15 minutes of actual arrival and departure. Failure to mark attendance, even if physically present, may be treated as absence unless corrected through the process described below.

7. Late Arrival Rules

Arriving after 10:30 AM without prior communication to the Reporting Manager is considered a late arrival. TCS allows up to **3 late arrivals per month** without formal action. From the 4th late arrival in a calendar month:

- A system-generated notification is sent to the employee and Reporting Manager.
- Half a day of Casual Leave is deducted for every 2 additional late arrivals beyond the permitted 3.
- Persistent late arrival (more than 6 instances in a rolling 3-month period) may result in a formal counseling session with HR and the Reporting Manager.

8. Early Departure

Employees needing to leave before 5:30 PM must inform their Reporting Manager in advance and log the reason in the Attendance module. Repeated early departure without approval is treated in the same manner as late arrival under this policy.

9. Unauthorized Absence

Absence from work without an approved leave request in the Leave Management System is classified as **unauthorized absence**. This includes situations where an employee informs a manager informally (via chat, call, or email) but does not submit and receive approval for a formal leave request, as required under the Leave Policy (TCS-HR-002).

Consequences of unauthorized absence include:

- Loss of pay for the day(s) of absence.

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- The absence being recorded as a policy violation in the employee's attendance record.
 - For absence exceeding 3 consecutive working days without communication, the matter is escalated to HR and may be treated as job abandonment, potentially leading to disciplinary action up to termination, per the Code of Conduct (TCS-HR-014).

10. Attendance Correction

If an employee forgets to mark biometric or digital attendance, or if there is a discrepancy in recorded hours, they can raise an **Attendance Correction Request** through the employee portal within 3 working days of the discrepancy, providing a reason and, where applicable, evidence such as a calendar invite or system access log. Corrections are reviewed and approved by the Reporting Manager and updated by HR within 2 working days.

11. Attendance Tracking

Attendance data is consolidated monthly by the HR Operations team and used for payroll processing, leave reconciliation, and performance review inputs. Employees can view their attendance summary at any time under 'My Attendance' on the employee portal. Significant attendance irregularities are reviewed quarterly by HRBPs with respective Reporting Managers.

12. Overtime Rules

Overtime work must be pre-approved by the Reporting Manager and logged in the Attendance module. Non-exempt employees (grades T1–T3) who work beyond 9 hours on a given day, or on a declared holiday/weekly off, are eligible for overtime compensation at 1.5x the standard hourly rate, or compensatory time off, as chosen by the employee subject to manager approval. Employees at grade M1 (Manager) and above are not eligible for overtime pay but may avail compensatory off for weekend work exceeding 4 hours, subject to manager approval.

13. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: What happens if I arrive late?

A: Up to 3 late arrivals per month are allowed without action. Beyond that, half a day of Casual Leave is deducted for every 2 additional late arrivals, and persistent lateness may lead to formal counseling.

Q: How can I correct an attendance mistake?

A: Raise an Attendance Correction Request on the employee portal within 3 working days, providing a reason and any supporting evidence. Your manager reviews and approves the correction.

Q: What are the standard working hours?

A: 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM IST, Monday to Friday, with a flexible start window between 8:30 AM and 10:30 AM provided Core Hours (11:00 AM–4:00 PM) are honored.

Q: What happens if I take leave without getting approval?

A: It is classified as unauthorized absence, resulting in loss of pay and, for extended unexplained absence, possible disciplinary action. Always apply and receive approval through the LMS as described in the Leave Policy (TCS-HR-002).

14. Contact Information

HR Operations (Attendance)	attendance.ops@tcs-internal.com Ext. 1102
Employee Portal — Attendance Module	portal.tcs-internal.com/attendance